

Empathy Map Canvas

Ideation Phase — Empathize & Discover

Project Name	Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow
Phase	Phase 1: Ideation
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Platform / Domain	ServiceNow / IT Service Management (ITSM)
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Maximum Marks	4 Marks

About Empathy Map Canvas

An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviours and attitudes. It is a powerful tool that helps teams better understand their users by considering things from the user's perspective, alongside their goals and challenges. Creating an effective solution requires understanding the true problem and the person experiencing it.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/empathy-map-canvas>

Persona: The IT Staff / Network Requester

SAYS — Quotes and spoken concerns

- I need VPN access for remote work, when will it be ready?
- I don't know the status of my request — no one has updated me.
- Who should I contact for approval? There is no clear owner.
- There should be an easier, centralized process for this.
- Need approval confirmed before the SLA window expires.

THINKS — Unspoken thoughts and questions

- Has my request been approved yet? No one told me.
- Will the IT team process this fast enough to meet my deadline?
- What if my request gets lost in someone's inbox?

- There should be a portal where I can submit and track everything.
- Why does every network change require so many phone calls?

FEELS — Emotions and inner state

- Frustrated by the entirely manual, fragmented process.
- Anxious about missing the SLA deadline for a critical project.
- Worried that the request may be overlooked or deprioritized.
- Uncertain about where in the process the request currently sits.
- Relieved only once an email confirmation of approval finally arrives.

DOES — Visible actions and behaviors

- Submits network requests via email to IT team distribution lists.
- Sends follow-up messages or phone calls to check approval status.
- Checks email notifications and chat channels regularly for updates.
- Shares supporting documentation with the IT operations team manually.
- Follows up repeatedly on approval status until confirmed.

Key Insights & Design Implications

Centralized Portal Need	Users consistently express a need for a single portal where they can submit, track, and manage all network requests without chasing multiple contacts.
Visibility Gap	The most dominant emotional state is uncertainty — users have no real-time insight into request progress, leading to anxiety and repeated manual follow-ups.
Automation Imperative	Manual approval chains create bottlenecks and SLA risks. Automated routing, notifications, and escalation are critical to user satisfaction.
Structured Intake Forms	The lack of standardized data collection leads to incomplete requests and clarification cycles. Dynamic, validated forms will eliminate this friction.